

Our God, Our Help In Ages Past

Words: Isaac Watts, 1719. Music: 'St. Anne' William Croft, 1708.

Setting: composite found in "The Lutheran Hymnary", 1913.

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$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score is written for a four-part choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. It is in the key of B-flat major (two flats) and 4/4 time. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The score consists of two systems of music. The first system contains the first five verses of the hymn. The second system contains the last two verses. The piano accompaniment is written in the right and left hands, with the right hand often playing chords and the left hand providing a steady bass line. The vocal parts are written in four staves, with the Soprano part at the top and the Bass part at the bottom. The lyrics are printed below the vocal staves, aligned with the corresponding notes.

1. Our God, our help in a - ges past, Our hope for years to come,
2. Un - der the sha - dow of Thy throne Thy saints have dwelt se - cure;
3. Be - fore the hills in or - der stood, Or earth re - ceived her frame,
4. Thy Word com - mands our flesh to dust, 'Re - turn, ye sons of men:'
5. A thou - sand a - ges in Thy sight Are like an eve - ning gone;

7

6. The busy tribes of flesh and blood,
With all their lives and cares,
Are carried downwards by the flood,
And lost in following years.

7. Time, like an ever rolling stream,
Bears all its sons away;
They fly, forgotten, as a dream
Dies at the opening day.

8. Like flowery fields the nations stand
Pleased with the morning light;
The flowers beneath the mower's hand
Lie withering ere 'tis night.

9. Our God, our help in ages past,
Our hope for years to come,
Be Thou our guard while troubles last,
And our eternal home.